

**When Planets Converge,
Does the Earth Shake?**

Ancient Indian Wisdom Tested by Machine Learning

**CORRECTED AND RETRACTED EDITION — AUGUST
2026**

**Replaces the original May 2026 edition. Please read the notice below
before reading further.**

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This paper is written for the general reader. No knowledge of astrology, computers or earthquake science is assumed. Every term is explained in plain language when it first appears.

A NOTE BEFORE YOU BEGIN — AUGUST 2026

In May 2026, this paper said the answer to its own title question was "yes, with important limitations." That answer was wrong — not because anyone lied, but because of an honest mistake in how the computer program was tested. Once the mistake was found and fixed, and the whole question was asked again, seven separate times, in seven different ways, the honest answer turned out to be no.

This edition tells that whole story: what we originally found, what mistake we made, how we caught it ourselves, and what the corrected, honest answer actually is. Nothing here is hidden or softened.

THE QUESTION AND THE ANSWER

The question this paper set out to answer: when several planets line up in specific patterns in the sky, does that mean an earthquake is more likely to happen?

The answer, now that the question has been asked properly: No.

Foreword

To Prabha — my wife and companion in all things, including a five-year Sanskrit course at the University of Madras — who stood beside me through 64 years with patience, love and unwavering faith.

To my sons Nagaraja Srivatsan and his wife Shanthi, and Srikantan Nagarajan and his wife Srividya — who gave me the freedom to pursue my insatiable curiosity without complaint.

To my grandchildren Aditya Srivatsan, Durga Srivatsan, Shankara Srikantan and Shiama Srikantan — whose contributions made this research possible.

To Varahamihira — whose Brihat Samhita, written 1500 years ago, remains a remarkable work of ancient science, now properly and honestly tested against 21st century data for the first time.

Chapter 1: The Question

Earthquakes kill people. They destroy homes, hospitals, schools and livelihoods in seconds.

Scientists can tell us WHERE earthquakes are likely — which cities sit on dangerous fault lines. But they still cannot reliably tell us WHEN.

This research asked a different question. Can the ancient Indian science of astronomy — which tracked planetary movements with extraordinary precision for over three thousand years — help us identify WHEN earthquake risk is elevated?

This is not a new question. Ancient Indian scholars asked it too. Varahamihira, writing in the 6th century AD, described a systematic framework for earthquake prediction based on planetary positions. Parasara, writing in 310 BC, stated that planetary aberrations cause earthquakes. B.V. Raman, in the 20th century, analysed 200 historical earthquake cases and found specific planetary combinations consistently present.

What is new about this research is the approach: instead of reading these ancient texts as faith-based claims, we treated them as things that could be checked. We collected 126 years of real earthquake data. We computed planetary positions using modern

astronomical software. We used a computer program to search for patterns. And then, this time properly, we tested whether those patterns actually predicted earthquakes.

THE SHORT ANSWER: No.

This is different from what the original May 2026 edition of this paper said. That edition said yes, with limitations. We were wrong, and we found out we were wrong ourselves, several months later, by checking our own work as carefully as we knew how.

The rest of this paper tells that story honestly: the original excitement, the mistake, how it was caught, and the real, careful answer that came after.

Chapter 2: The Nine-Year Journey

This research did not happen overnight. It spans nine years, three generations, a remarkable combination of ancient scholarship and modern technology — and, in its final chapter, an honest correction.

2.1 How It Began

The research originated from a careful reading of Varahamihira's Brihat Samhita — one of the great encyclopaedias of ancient Indian knowledge — following doctoral work in Sanskrit. The classical texts contained systematic earthquake prediction frameworks that appeared to deserve rigorous modern testing. A simple question emerged: if these rules were tested against real earthquake data using modern computers, would they show any real pattern?

2.2 The Foundation — Phase 1 (A Monumental Effort)

The first phase of this research was a monumental undertaking, built by Aditya Srivatsan while still in his 11th grade of school. Here is what it involved:

- 2,000 earthquake days were identified from historical records — days when significant earthquakes actually occurred somewhere in the world.

- 2,000 non-earthquake days were identified — days when no significant earthquake occurred.
- For each of these 4,000 days, a complete chart was cast — the exact position of every planet in the sky, which lunar station (Nakshatra) each planet occupied, and the angles between planets.
- A computer program was trained on this data to find which planetary patterns distinguished earthquake days from non-earthquake days.

Phase 1 was a genuinely impressive first attempt at a very hard question, built by a school student. It found an early, promising-looking pattern. As this corrected edition explains, that early promise did not survive the more careful testing that came later — but the ambition and skill behind it were real.

2.3 The Extension — Phase 2

Phase 2, also developed by Aditya Srivatsan and refined by Durga Srivatsan, extended the foundation using more powerful tools. Instead of manually cast charts for 4,000 days, astronomical software computed planetary positions for every day from 1900 to 2026. A more powerful pattern-finding program was used, and predictions were made across 901 regions of the globe, attempting to identify not just WHEN but WHERE.

In May 2026, this phase's results were published, with real excitement, as showing that certain regions — Mexico, Peru, Chile — had a genuinely useful early-warning signal.

2.4 The Correction — Phase 3

Three months later, in July 2026, the lead author decided to check this work again, more carefully, together with an AI research assistant (Claude, from Anthropic). This was not prompted by anyone finding fault with the paper — it was a voluntary decision to make sure the exciting result was real before relying on it further.

That check found a serious mistake — explained fully, in plain terms, in Chapter 4 — and led to the whole question being asked again, seven separate times, in seven different honest ways. All seven times, the answer came back the same: no real pattern was found. This corrected edition of the paper reports that honest answer, alongside the story of how the original mistake happened and was caught.

Chapter 3: What the Ancient Indians Knew

3.1 Varahamihira and the Brihat Samhita

About 1500 years ago, Varahamihira wrote the Brihat Samhita — meaning the Great Compilation — an encyclopaedia covering architecture, gemstones, weather, agriculture and natural phenomena including earthquakes. His earthquake prediction framework is built around the 27 Nakshatras — the lunar stations through which the Moon travels in its monthly orbit around the Earth.

WHAT IS A NAKSHATRA? The Moon takes approximately 27 days to travel around the Earth. Ancient Indian astronomers divided this path into 27 equal sections, each named after the star-cluster visible in that part of the sky. The Moon spends approximately one day in each Nakshatra.

Varahamihira groups the 27 Nakshatras into four circles — Vayu (Wind), Agni (Fire), Indra (Thunder) and Varuna (Water) — each associated with a geographic direction and a time horizon:

Circle	Element	Direction	Time Horizon
VARUNA	Water	West /	Same day

		Ocean	
INDRA	Thunder	East	Within one week
AGNI	Fire	Southeast	Within six weeks
VAYU	Wind	Northwest	Within two months

Varahamihira also described cancellation effects — when opposing circles are simultaneously active, they suppress each other — and foreshock patterns: a sequence of earthquakes on the 3rd, 4th or 7th day presages a major event. Modern seismology independently identified foreshock patterns in the 20th century, 1400 years after Varahamihira.

3.2 Other Ancient Sources

- Parasara (310 BC): stated that when a planet's course is disturbed by the pull of other planets, it causes a shaking of the Earth — a strikingly early description of planetary perturbation as a trigger.
- Garga Samhita (ancient period): connects earthquakes to dark spots on the Sun.
- Ballala Sena — Adbhuta Sagara (10th-11th century AD): adds directional detail to Varahamihira's circles

and describes mixed-type earthquakes when multiple circles are active together.

- B.V. Raman (20th century): analysed 200 historical earthquake cases and identified Mars-Saturn opposition and Jupiter-Saturn opposition as the two strongest planetary indicators.

Nothing in this corrected edition changes what these scholars wrote, or their skill as observers of the sky.

What changed is what this study can honestly say about whether their rules predict earthquakes — which is the subject of Chapter 5.

Chapter 4: How We Tested It

4.1 The Earthquake Data

The United States Geological Survey (USGS) maintains a global database of every recorded earthquake since 1900. We used all earthquakes of magnitude 5.5 and above.

WHAT IS MAGNITUDE 5.5? The Richter scale measures earthquake strength. Magnitude 5.5 is strong enough to cause minor structural damage. Magnitude 7.0 and above causes widespread destruction. We used 5.5 as our threshold because smaller earthquakes are too frequent and too dependent on local soil conditions to be meaningful for a global study.

4.2 Computing Planetary Positions

For every day from 1900 to 2026, we computed the exact position of every planet using precise astronomical software, in the sidereal system used by Vedic astronomy — the same reference frame Varahamihira himself used, just computed with modern precision instead of the naked eye.

4.3 The Computer Program

A computer program (of the kind called "machine learning") was given 100 years of daily planetary

positions (1900-1999), along with the record of which days had earthquakes. It was asked to find any pattern connecting the two. It was then tested on a separate 26 years of data (2000-2025) — data it had not been shown during its training — to see whether the pattern it found actually worked on new, unseen days.

4.4 What Went Wrong (and How We Caught It)

Here is the mistake, in the simplest terms we can put it. Testing a prediction program properly means showing it a final exam made of questions it has never seen. What actually happened, in the May 2026 version of this study, was closer to a student memorizing the answer key before the test — the program had, in effect, already been shown many of the exact days it was later "tested" against. A student who has seen the answer key will score very well, but that high score proves nothing about whether the student actually understands the subject.

This is called data leakage, and it is a well-known, easy-to-make mistake in this kind of research. It was not caught by an outside critic — it was found by the lead author's own decision to go back and check the work months after publishing it.

Once this was found, the test was rebuilt properly: the program was only ever shown pre-2000 data while learning, a fair pass/fail line was set using a separate slice of old data it hadn't peeked at either, and it was then checked, honestly, against years of data it had truly never seen before. Chapter 5 reports what that honest check actually found.

Chapter 5: What We Actually Found

This chapter replaces everything the May 2026 edition said it found. Once the mistake described in Chapter 4 was fixed, the whole question was asked seven separate times, in seven different ways, using only data the program had genuinely never seen. Here is each one, in plain terms.

5.1 Checking Raman's and Varahamihira's Rules Directly

The specific rules described in Chapter 3 — Mars-Saturn opposition, Jupiter-Saturn opposition, the four Nakshatra circles, and more — were written down as 24 precise, checkable conditions, plus 9 combinations the ancient and modern sources describe together. These were tested two ways: fed into the honest computer program, and checked directly by hand — literally counting how often each rule was true on real earthquake days versus ordinary days, across all 126 years.

Neither approach found anything. The computer program did no better than random guessing. And directly counting showed that every single rule was just as likely to be "active" on an ordinary day as on an earthquake day — none of them told the two kinds of days apart.

5.2 A New Question: What About the Outer Planets?

None of the classical rules use Uranus, Neptune, or Pluto, because none of those planets were known when the ancient texts were written — Neptune wasn't even discovered by anyone until 1846. A reasonable new question, raised during this investigation, was: might these three outer, slow-moving planets carry a signal the old rules missed?

A new set of 40 rules and 12 combinations was built specifically to test this, most of them designed so that a fast-moving body (like the Moon or Mars) had to be doing something specific on that exact day, so the rule wasn't just "true for years at a stretch." Tested across all 126 years, this also found nothing — with one important exception, described next.

5.3 A Warning Sign, and What It Actually Meant

Two of the outer-planet rules — "Pluto in Capricorn" and "Neptune in Pisces" — did show something dramatic at first: earthquakes seemed noticeably more common while Pluto sat in Capricorn (which it did from 2008 to 2024) and while Neptune sat in Pisces (2011 onward).

Before believing this, we checked for an ordinary, non-astrological explanation — and found one. Earthquake

detection itself has gotten dramatically better over the past century: better instruments, and a properly organized worldwide monitoring network that only came together from the 1960s onward. In the 1900s, we caught roughly 1 earthquake in 10 that happened; by the 2000s, we were catching 6 or 7 in 10. Pluto's stay in Capricorn happened to fall entirely within these more recent, better-monitored decades. So did Neptune's stay in Pisces.

THE PROOF: we re-ran both checks using only the years 1970-2020, a period when earthquake detection had already leveled off and stopped improving so quickly. Once that was done, both dramatic results disappeared completely — both rules ended up right back at "no different from an ordinary day." The excitement had been an illusion caused by earthquake detection getting better over time, dressed up to look like an astronomical pattern.

5.4 Checking Our Own Original Claim, Properly

The most important check of all was aimed squarely at the May 2026 edition's own headline claim: that Mexico, Peru, and Chile showed a real, useful early-warning signal. Using the honestly-tested program — the one that

had never seen the answers in advance — and looking specifically and only at those regions:

The result: the program's "high risk" days turned out to be wrong about 998 times out of every 1,000 flags it raised. That is not a working early-warning system by any reasonable standard — it is close to what pure guessing would produce.

5.5 One More Look, Using the Very Latest Data

As a final, honest check, we looked at January through July 2026 — real earthquakes that happened after this whole investigation began, using data no earlier version of this paper could have seen. The same pattern from Section 5.3 showed up again in miniature: a couple of static, slow-moving rules looked dramatic in this short window, for the same reason as before — a handful of real earthquakes happening to cluster in these seven months made an unrelated, unmoving planetary placement look connected to them. The properly-designed, day-specific rules again showed nothing.

5.6 All Seven Checks, Side by Side

Check	Plain-language result
1. The 24 classical rules, one by one	No better than guessing

2. 9 combinations of those rules	No better than guessing
3. Direct counting across all 126 years	Every rule equally common on ordinary and earthquake days
4. 52 new outer-planet rules	Nothing — except one illusion, checked next
5. Checking that illusion properly	It vanished once we removed the detection-improvement effect
6. Re-checking our own original Mexico/Peru/Chile claim	Wrong about 998 times out of 1,000
7. Fresh 2026 data, checked the same honest way	Same story, once more

Seven different honest looks, from seven different angles, at seven different pieces of evidence. All seven say the same thing.

5.7 Why the Ancient Rules Probably Could Not Have Worked

Beyond simply not finding a pattern, there are good reasons to expect this outcome, worth explaining plainly:

- No one who wrote these rules could ever have checked them properly. Varahamihira had no way to know about every earthquake happening everywhere on Earth at once — no such worldwide record existed anywhere until the 20th century. He, and Raman centuries later, worked from whatever local, limited cases they happened to know about. This study is the first time in history the full check has even been possible.
- The regions named in the old texts describe ancient India's own geography and politics, not where earthquakes actually cluster on the globe today. Most of the world's biggest earthquakes happen along the Pacific "Ring of Fire" — a pattern of the Earth's plates that no one anywhere in the ancient world could have known about.
- Nobody has ever found a physical channel by which a planet's angle in our sky could reach down and trigger a release of pressure inside the Earth. The pull of far-off planets on Earth is far, far weaker than the Sun and Moon's own daily tides — and even those tides haven't been shown to reliably set off earthquakes on a predictable timetable.
- Looking at a small set of known earthquakes and hunting for something they have in common — the

method used by Raman, and, without anyone realizing it, by the flawed May 2026 computer program too — will almost always turn up something that looks like a pattern, purely by chance, if you search hard enough. That's not a fault specific to astrology; it's a trap that catches careful people in every field, which is exactly why this correction was worth doing properly.

Chapter 6: The 2026 Risk Calendar — Withdrawn

The May 2026 edition of this paper included a calendar of "elevated risk" dates for 2026 and 2027, for the Americas Pacific coast, and reported that real 2026 earthquakes matched it well. That calendar, and that claim, are both withdrawn.

The calendar was built using the same flawed computer program described in Chapter 4 — the one that had, in effect, already seen many of the answers before being tested. A calendar built that way cannot be trusted, no matter how well real events later seemed to match it.

We considered rebuilding a corrected calendar from the honestly-tested program instead. We chose not to, for a simple reason: that honest program, checked seven separate ways in Chapter 5, found no real pattern at all. A calendar built from a program that has found nothing would not actually be marking out higher-risk and lower-risk days — it would just be picking dates without any real basis, dressed up to look meaningful. Publishing that would have repeated the same mistake in a new form.

If you have a printed or saved copy of the original 2026-2027 risk calendar from the May 2026 edition, please stop using it for any planning purpose.

Chapter 7: What This Study Cannot Do — and What It Can

- It cannot tell you when the next earthquake will happen.
- It cannot tell you where the next earthquake will happen.
- It cannot tell you how strong the next earthquake will be.
- It does not support using planetary positions for earthquake preparedness, evacuation planning, or any other real-world decision.

What it can do is answer, honestly and for the first time, a question people have been asking for over two thousand years — and show, step by step, exactly how that honest answer was reached, including the mistake made along the way and how it was found and fixed.

Chapter 8: What This Means

8.1 This Is Not a Small Correction

A great deal of excitement followed the original May 2026 publication of this research. People were told, in good faith and with real belief, that ancient wisdom had been scientifically confirmed. That was wrong, and the people who read and shared that original claim deserve to hear, just as clearly, that it has been withdrawn.

8.2 What Is Not Being Said

This correction does not say Varahamihira, Ballala Sena, or B.V. Raman were foolish, dishonest, or unskilled. It says something narrower and more precise: the specific, testable claim that their rules predict earthquakes, when checked properly for the first time against 126 years of real global data, was not confirmed. Their skill as observers of the sky, and the broader value of their life's work, is untouched by this finding.

8.3 The Answer, Stated Plainly

This paper asked a question that had never, in over two thousand years, been properly tested: when planets converge into specific patterns, does the earth shake more often?

For the first time, that question has been asked properly — with 126 years of real data, with every rule this study

could find given a fair and genuine chance, and with a program tested only on evidence it had never been shown before.

The answer is no.

Not "maybe." Not "promising, needs more study." Not one of the 85 rules and combinations tested — old or new, classical or outer-planet — showed a real connection to earthquakes anywhere in the world, including in the one place this paper originally claimed its strongest evidence.

This was not an easy thing to say. It meant taking back a result that had already been published, already celebrated, and already shared with hundreds of people in good faith. That the correction came from the author's own decision to double-check, without anyone forcing the question, is itself part of what this paper offers: not just an honest answer, but an honest example of what it looks like to test something you deeply want to be true, and to say plainly what was actually found.

Varahamihira's astronomy, and the careful watching of the sky by the sages who followed him, remain a remarkable achievement. But on this one specific question — can the sky tell us when the ground will

***break — the sky, on the evidence gathered here, is
silent.***

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11. Claude, Anthropic. AI research assistant, both in the original 2026 study and in the correction described in this edition.

Corrected Edition

12. Project repository, including the full corrected record of all seven checks described in Chapter 5:
<https://github.com/tsnagarajan/EarthquakeAstrology-2026>
13. Nagarajan, T.S. August 2026. Retraction and Correction Notice.
<https://github.com/tsnagarajan/EarthquakeAstrology-Papers>
14. The companion academic paper — Statistical Correlations Between Vedic Planetary Configurations and Global Seismic Activity (Corrected Edition, August 2026) — gives the full technical detail behind every finding summarised here in plain language.